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The Verbless Clause in Biblical Hebrew

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Thematic Continuity and the Conditioning of Word Order in Verbless Clauses

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1. Introduction

In this paper I explore the implications of the choice of a particular form of clause for use in a particular context rather than attempt to establish an essential meaning that a particular form of clause must carry in any context. The corpus studied is formed by the verbless clauses (including those with participial predicate) in the books of Judges, Samuel, and Kings. The study is restricted to clauses in declarative form. Interrogative clauses are not included, and there is no question of modal clauses. The vast majority of the verbless clauses are coordinate (introduced by the conjunction *waw*), asyndeton (with no introductory particle), or **ו** clauses (introduced by the particle **ו**).¹ This study is restricted to members of these groups. Description of relative position is here based on the head of the structure. In a clause with the structure adverbial-head A-head B, where the adverbial modifies head B, head A is said to be "in first position," with the adverbial "preposed." In a clause showing "leftward dislocation," with constituents nominal-pronoun-head B, where the pronoun is co-referent with the nominal, the pronoun is said to be head A, in first position. The nominal is "extraposed."² This permits the treatment of all verbless clauses together. The study begins with a survey of

1. In this study, the designation "**ו** clause" refers to clauses that present either something known (or perceived) about a theme in the previous context, as in example (10), or some explanatory circumstance related to a theme, as in (11). Other functions of **ו** are not represented.

2. A structure of this sort is used to draw attention to a theme that is new, has not been mentioned recently, or is unexpectedly replacing another. In a few cases, the co-referent item is a pronoun in an adverbial constituent, as in Judg 17:5 and 1 Kgs 7:30, or is a nominal, as in 1 Sam 14:49.

clauses in which one constituent is a third-person pronoun, since relationship to the context is most easily evaluated in these.

2. One Constituent of the Clause Is a Third-Person Pronoun

2.1. The Pronoun Stands in First Position (Pro1)

Coordinate clauses showing Pro1 order are most commonly used to add some detail, some "circumstance," to the information supplied in the preceding clause:

(1) Judg 3:20

וַיָּהֹוד בָּא אֵלָיו וְהוּא יֹשֵׁב בְּעֵלִית הַמִּקְרָה אֲשֶׁר-לוֹ לְבָדּוֹ	[Ehud came to him,] and he (was) sitting in the cool upstairs room which he had, alone.
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Asyndeton clauses showing Pro1 order are used in a similar way; they add detail to the information previously presented:

(2) 1 Kgs 3:27

[תִּנּוּ-לָהּ אֶת-הַיָּלִיד הַחַי וְהַמָּת לֹא תִמְיתֶהוּ] הִיא אָמַר:	[Give her the living child, and on no account kill him.] She (is) his mother.
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An asyndeton clause of this type is sometimes used at the beginning of a new unit of text as the first of a pair presenting synchronous events:

(3) Judg 18:3

הָמָּה עִם-בֵּית מִיכָה [וְהָמָּה] הִכִּירוּ אֶת-קוֹל הַנָּעַר הַלֵּוִי]	They (were) at Micah's house, [and they recognized the voice of the Levite lad.]
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A coordinate clause is occasionally used as the first of a synchronous pair of this type, as in 1 Kgs 1:22 (cf. 1 Kgs 1:42) and 2 Kgs 2:23.

The corpus includes 95 examples of these standard forms of Pro1 order (A1).³

2.2. Less-Common Uses

The order Pro1 is typical where some component of the nonpronominal constituent other than its head begins the clause:

3. The letter A followed by a number refers to a section of the appendix (pp. 316–19) of this paper. "The corpus" should include all verbless clauses of the type studied in Judges, Samuel, and Kings. However, collection of the examples was manual and inclusion or exclusion may occasionally be arbitrary and idiosyncratic, so the figures given are best taken as approximations.

(4) 2 Kgs 17:34

עד היום הזה הם עשים
כמשפטים הראשנים Until today they (are) following
the original customs.

Other examples occur in Judg 6:24, 1 Sam 17:5, 2 Kgs 17:40, and, in *כי* clauses presenting explanation, in Judg 14:4; 2 Sam 9:13; and 2 Kgs 12:16, 22:7.

Pro1 order is also typical where the referent of the pronoun is presented as an extraposed nominal:

(5) 1 Sam 17:14

וְדָוִד הוּא הַקָּטָן And David—he (was) the youngest.

The corpus includes 16 examples (A2).

Apart from cases in which the clause has a preposed component or an extraposed nominal, as in (4) and (5), Pro1 order occurs in a clause beginning a speech only in 2 Sam 9:4:

(6) 2 Sam 9:4

[וַיֹּאמֶר צִיבָא אֶל-הַמֶּלֶךְ] [Ziba said to the king] “Look, he
הִנֵּה-הוּא בֵּית מַכִּיר בֶּן-עֲמִיאל (is) at the house of Machir
בְּלוֹ דָּבָר: b. Ammiel in Lo-davar.”⁴

The usual order in such clauses is Pro2; see (9).

Pro1 order occurs in a few examples in which the clause is introduced by *כי*:

(7) 1 Kgs 2:22

כִּי הוּא אָחִי הַגָּדוֹל מִמֶּנִּי For he (is) my elder brother.

Other examples occur in 1 Kgs 3:4, 5:4, 9:22, 21:2. The usual order in such clauses is Pro2; see (10), (11).

Pro1 order also occurs in a clause coordinate with one introduced by *כי*:

(8) 1 Sam 17:33

[לֹא תוּכַל לִלְחֹם אֶל-הַפִּלִּשְׁתִּי] [You cannot go against this
הַזֶּה . . . כִּי-נָעַר אַתָּה] Philistine . . . for a lad you (are)],
אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה מִנוְעָרָיו: and he (has been) a warrior from his
youth.

Compare (12), (13).

2.3. The Pronoun Stands in Second Position (Pro2)

Pro2 order is typical in asyndeton clauses that begin a speech:

4. The speaker responds to a question by the king. Possibly the order represents formal usage.

(9) 1 Sam 19:14

[וַיִּשְׁלַח שָׁאוּל מַלְאָכִים לִקְחֹת
אֶת-דָּוִד וְתָאמַרְ [חֲלָה הוּא:
[Saul sent messengers to get David,
and she (Michal) said,] "He (is) ill."

The corpus includes 11 examples (A3).

Pro2 order is also usual in clauses introduced by כִּי. Examples occur in Judg 18:26 (10) and 8:24 (11):

(10) Judg 18:26

[וַיֵּלְכוּ בְנֵי-דָן לְדֹרֶכָם וַיֵּרָא
מִיכָה] כִּי-חֲזָקִים הָמָּה מִמֶּנּוּ
[The b. Dan went on their way, and
Micah realized] that they (were)
stronger than he. . . .

(11) Judg 8:24

[נִזְמִי זָהָב לָהֶם] כִּי יִשְׁמַעְאֵלִים
הֵם: [They had gold rings,] because
they (were) Ishmaelites.

The corpus includes 33 examples of a כִּי clause with Pro2 order (A4).

2.4. Less-Common Uses

Pro2 order may also occur in a clause coordinate with one for which that order is characteristic, for example, after introductory כִּי:

(12) 2 Sam 17:8

[אַתָּה יָדַעַת . . . אֶת-אֲנָשָׁיו
כִּי גִבֹּרִים הֵמָּה] וַיִּמְרֵי נֶפֶשׁ הָמָּה
[You know his men, that heroic
(are) they] and embittered (are)
they.

This occurs where כִּי is not involved:

(13) Judg 18:7

[וַיֵּרְאוּ אֶת-הָעָם אֲשֶׁר-בְּקִרְבָּהּ
יֹשְׁבֹת-לְבֶטֶח . . . שָׁקֵט
וּבִטָּה . . .] וַיִּרְחָקוּ הָמָּה
מִצְדֹנִים [They saw the people who were in
it living securely . . . quiet, secure
. . .] and distant (were) they from
the Sidonians. . . .

The phrases preceding the clause in question are, like the nominal constituent of the clause, descriptive.⁵ Like them, the clause presents a fact perceived about the referent of the pronominal constituent, information more often presented by a clause introduced by כִּי.

5. The first of the excised passages represented by the dots is an adverbial phrase modifying the preceding nominal phrase; the second contains two nominal phrases that are obscure in meaning but used syntactically (as far as one can tell) parallel with the others. The phrases, of course, represent perceptions about "the people," such as are more commonly presented in clauses introduced by כִּי, as in (10).

Pro2 order also occurs after a speech-initial asyndeton clause, in a coordinate clause in 1 Kgs 20:28, and in a parallel asyndeton clause in 1 Sam 20:26, where the pronouns in the two clauses have different referents.

Pro2 order occasionally occurs where Pro1 is expected under the general description:

(14) 1 Kgs 11:14

[וַיָּקָם יְהוָה . . . אֶת הַרְדָּ
הָאֱדֹמִי מִזֶּרַע הַמֶּלֶךְ הוּא
בְּאֶדְוֹם:] [Yahweh raised up . . . Hadad the
Edomite.] From the royal family he
(was), in Edom.

There is a similar example in narrative in 1 Kgs 7:14 and one in speech in 2 Sam 13:20.

Pro2 order occurs after an extraposed nominal in 2 Kgs 7:9:

(15) 2 Kgs 7:9

הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה יוֹם-בִּשְׂרָה הוּא This day a day of tidings it (is).

Another example occurs in 2 Sam 21:2 and two in 1 Kgs 20:3.

2.5. Summary

In a clause of which one constituent is a third-person pronoun, this pronominal constituent most commonly stands in first position. Where this is the case, the relationship of a coordinate or asyndeton clause to what precedes is much like that of an *אשר* clause: it presents some item of information about the referent of the pronoun.⁶ The situation is the same where the clause is first in a synchronous pair (see [3]). A pair of clauses of this sort effects a transition from one phase of the action to the next. The pair initiates a new phase of the action, but the pronoun links the pair with the referent in the preceding context. The initial position of the pronoun gives prominence to this link.

Where a third-person pronominal constituent is used in the first clause of a speech, the speech commonly responds to speech by another, in which the theme represented by the pronoun is also mentioned. In some cases, the speech to which response is made is not given in the text (as in [9]), and the speech may respond to an action or event, rather than to another speech, as in 1 Sam 20:26 and 2 Kgs 9:36. Nevertheless, the fact that a pronoun is used shows that its referent is clearly established as theme in the mind of the

6. In the corpus, a two-part verbless clause is introduced by *אשר* in some 55 cases. A third-person pronoun forms (the head of) one constituent in 13 of these. Clearly, coordinate verbless clauses with a third-person pronominal constituent must carry a good deal of the load for which an ordinary relative clause might have been used. A participle with the definite article is similarly often used as a modifier where a relative clause might be used, as one is in 1 Kgs 5:13.

speaker, and (at least in the speaker's view) also in the mind of the addressee. It seems reasonable to argue that the relationship is so clearly established in such cases that it is not necessary to draw attention to it by placing the pronoun in initial position. This can be used to give prominence to the new information presented in the other constituent of the clause.

The use of כִּי to introduce a clause shows, in the examples available, that (unlike coordinate or asyndeton clauses) the clause stands in a specific relationship to what precedes. Consequently, the new information can be given the prominence of first position; there is no need to place the pronoun first to draw attention to the relationship. In fact, where the clause presents something perceived or known about the referent of the pronoun, the relationship is so clearly marked that the pronoun is superfluous and is sometimes not used. Compare כִּי־טוֹב ('Good [was it]', Gen 1:4), with כִּי־טוֹב הוּא ('Good [was] it', Exod 2:2).⁷ In the other cases in which Pro2 order also occurs, the relationship of the clause to what precedes is not in doubt, being marked either by the introductory particle or by the situational context in which the clause is used. As with speech-initial clauses, the referent of the pronoun in these other types may not be represented in the preceding text but is clearly established as thematic in the context, as in 2 Kgs 18:36.

3. One Constituent of the Clause Is a Third-Person Pronoun with a Prefixed Preposition

The pronoun bound to the preposition represents a theme in the preceding text, as do pronouns elsewhere. The same theme may or may not be continued in what follows. Clauses in this group are mostly coordinate, with a few asyndeton examples used in the same way. The examples introduced by כִּי are noted below. The clauses occur within narrative or speech; none appears to begin a new section.

3.1. Typical Usage

Where the adverbial constituent (the preposition with pronoun) stands in first position (PPro1), the nominal constituent usually represents a nonhuman entity:

7. A third-person pronoun is occasionally not used in a כִּי clause that presents an explanation but only (as far as I am aware) in poetry, as in Ps 106:1. Similarly, the most common type of אשר clause is composed of אשר and an adverbial; the inclusion of a third-person pronoun (as in Judg 19:12; 1 Kgs 8:41, 9:20) is rare and so marked. Failure to use a pronoun (like failure to use a direct object with a verb that usually takes one) can of course be described in terms of grammatical or lexical difference but shows only that the speaker or writer considers the text to be intelligible without it.

(16) 1 Sam 10:5

[... וּפְגַעְתָּ חֶבֶל נְבִיאִים] [You will meet a band of prophets
וּלְפָנֵיהֶם נִבֵּל וְתֵף וְחִלָּל וְכִנּוּר . . . ,] and before them (will be)
musical instruments.

The corpus includes 14 examples (A5).

The referent of the nominal is also nonhuman in Judg 17:5, where PPro1 order is used following an extraposed nominal representing the referent of the pronoun.

Where the adverbial constituent stands in second position (PPro2), the nominal constituent usually represents participants, either an individual (God or human), or a group. The corpus includes 26 examples (A6), as in:

(17) 1 Kgs 18:7

[וַיְהִי עַבְדֵּיהוּ בַּדֶּרֶךְ] [Obadiah was on the road,] and here
אֵלֵיהוּ לִקְרֹאתוֹ (came) Elijah to meet him.

Usage typical for both PPro1 and PPro 2 occurs in Judg 19:10:

(18) Judg 19:10

[וַיָּקָם וַיֵּלֶךְ וַיָּבֹא . . .] [He rose, set out, and came . . .] and
צֶמֶד חֲמֹרִים חֲבוּשִׁים with him (was) a pair of saddled
וּפִילָגְשׁוֹ עִמּוֹ donkeys, and his concubine (was)
with him.⁸

3.2. Less-Common Examples with Initial Adverbial (PPro1)

Where the order PPro1 is used, the nominal constituent can typically be seen as representing an attribute of the referent of the pronoun, as in (16). This is usually a reasonable view in the few cases in which the referent of the nominal is human, as with family members:

(19) 1 Sam 17:12

[וַדָּוִד בֶּן-אִישׁ . . . וְשֵׁמוֹ יֵשׁוּ] [David was son of a man . . . whose
וְלֹ שְׁמֹנֶה בָּנִים name was Jesse,] and to him (were)
eight sons.

8. The value of the expected PPro2 order in the second of these clauses is not neutral (cf. the similar situation in the contrasting pair in [8]). The information in the two clauses could have been combined, as in the passage where the donkeys are first mentioned, in Judg 19:3, וַיֵּצֵא עִמּוֹ וְצֶמֶד חֲמֹרִים . . . וַיֵּלֶךְ 'He went . . . and his lad (was) with him, and a pair of donkeys'. The use of a separate clause to present the concubine, the use of PPro2 order, contrasting with the preceding clause, and the presentation of nonhuman before human, so that the mention of the concubine ends the unit, are all unusual features. They draw attention to this clause and thus alert the reader to the fact that the concubine will play a significant part in what follows.

Other examples occur in Judg 11:34 and 1 Sam 1:2. When a nominal in second position in a clause of this sort designates a group of supporters, they play no part in the context. The 3,000 chosen men with Saul in 1 Sam 26:2 do not participate in any conflict; they simply enhance the narrator's picture of David's danger.⁹ The 20 men with Joab in 2 Sam 3:20 indicate his status (and the extent of David's hospitality). The 50 men in 2 Kgs 15:25 have a similar function: the fight is over before they are mentioned.¹⁰ In 2 Sam 23:9, 23:11, the clauses 'after him (was) PN' (in a list) represent a different situation. The list context shows that the nominal represents the topic of the section introduced in this way. PPro1 order can be used to give prominence to thematic continuity.

PPro1 order is also used in three cases in which the initial adverbial is preceded by הנה (ו). This particle usually stands before a nominal, as in the example with PPro2 order in (17) (see also [6], [32]). In 2 Sam 15:32, where the clause has content very similar to (17), PPro1 order is used, also preceded by והנה.

(20) 2 Sam 15:32

[וַיְהִי דָּוִד בָּא עַד-הָרֹאשׁ . . .]	[David came to the peak . . .] and
וְהָיָה לְקִרְאָתוֹ חוּשַׁי הָאֲרָכִי . . .	here (came) Hushai the Archite to
	meet him. . .

It is reasonable to suggest that the use of הנה before an adverbial is marked and draws attention to the unusual position of the nominal, which is thus highlighted. This explanation would also be fitting in 1 Kgs 19:13 (cf. 1 Kgs 19:9). The same argument can be applied in 1 Kgs 19:6:

(21) 1 Kgs 19:6

[וַיִּבֹט] וְהָיָה מִרְאשֵׁתָיו עָגֹל	[He looked,] and here at his head-
רְצָפִים וְצִפְחַת מַיִם	place (was) a bannock and a flask
	of water.

PPro1 order is expected in this case because the nominal designates inanimate objects, but it is reasonable to suggest that the marked usage is intended to highlight their unexpected and significant appearance.¹¹

9. Other features of the context seem to serve the same purpose; see E. J. Revell, *The Designation of the Individual: Expressive Usage in Biblical Narrative* (Biblical Exegesis and Theology 14; Kampen: Kok Pharos, 1996) §§13.3.5, 16.3.5. However, PPro2 order is used in 1 Sam 17:41, where the nominal represents Goliath's shield-bearer, whose only function in the narrative appears to be to enhance the picture of Goliath as a menace to David. The description of the characteristics of the nominals that appear in either order can only give rise to generalizations. The choice of first position for one or other constituent depends on the communicative intention of the narrator.

10. In fact, it is not wholly clear which of the protagonists they are supporting.

11. The corpus does not include any כִּי clauses of this type that present what is perceived.

3.3. Less-Common Examples with Initial Nominal (PPro2)

Where PPro2 order is used, the individual or group designated by the nominal constituent can be understood to play an important part in the following events, although it may be implied, not described, as for example when Yahweh is named in Judg 1:22; 1 Sam 16:18, 18:14; and 2 Sam 5:10. PPro2 order is used in the six clauses of this type that are introduced by **כִּי**. In the examples in Judg 1:19 and 4:3, the initial nominal, '(900) chariots of iron', can be considered to represent a group of supporters and therefore typical for this order. In the other cases, the referent of the nominal is inanimate; thus PPro1 order would be expected, as in 1 Sam 13:6:

(22) 1 Sam 13:6

[וְאִישׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל רָאָה] כִּי צָר-לוֹ [The men of Israel saw] that trouble
(had come) to them.

Other examples occur in Judg 8:24 and 1 Kgs 18:27 (twice). The use of PPro2 order recalls the common use of Pro2 order in clauses introduced by **כִּי**.

PPro2 order is also used in Judg 18:28 in a clause coordinate with a clause introduced by **כִּי** (which has Pro2 order) and in Judg 18:7, in a similar situation (see [13]). In these cases, the relationship of the clause to what precedes is clear from the context, so there is no need to place the pronoun in first position to draw attention to it.

PPro2 order is characteristic of passages describing structures or objects for the same reason, as in 1 Kgs 7:28:

(23) 1 Kgs 7:28

[וְזֶה מַעֲשֵׂה הַמְּכוּנָה] [This (was) the structure of the
מִסְגֶּרֶת לָהֶם bases:] borders (were belonging)
to them.

Other examples occur in 1 Kgs 7:25, 7:35; 2 Kgs 25:17; and also in 1 Kgs 7:30, where the pronoun is co-referent with an extraposed nominal representing the referent of the pronoun.

PPro2 order is also used to give prominence to a nominal in a contrast or comparison with what precedes (Judg 10:4, 1 Sam 25:25). PPro2 order is probably similarly intended to draw attention to the referent of the nominal in 1 Kgs 19:19:

(24) 1 Kgs 19:19

[וַיֵּלֶךְ מִשָּׁם וַיִּמְצָא אֶת-אֵלִישָׁע] [He left there and met Elisha b.
בֶּן-שַׁפְט וְהוּא חֹרֵשׁ] Shaphat, and he (was) ploughing;]
עֶשְׂרֵי צִמְדִּים לִפְנָיו twelve yoke (were) before him.

Another example occurs in 1 Sam 19:16.

4. Analysis

It seems clear from the above description that the order of the constituents of a verbless clause is not determined either by their composition in terms of word class or by the particle used to introduce the clause. The explanations offered typically have a semantic basis. A variety of explanatory categories has been suggested. Since meaning is involved, it has proved difficult to set up a uniformly satisfactory categorization.¹² The terms used here are defined below.

4.1. Topic–Comment and Subject–Predicate

The term *topic* is used here to refer to one of the two constituents of a verbless clause, the other being called the *comment*.¹³ This pair of terms is, I believe, a suitable translation of the Arabic *mubtada'* and *ḥabar* recommended by Michel for reference to the two parts of a verbless clause.¹⁴ The terms *subject* and *predicate*, which Michel rejects, are generally seen as referring to the grammatical relationship of the parts.¹⁵ The *topic* of a clause is also usually its subject; this is not necessarily the case, but I have not noted any examples of verbless clauses in which the two are clearly distinct.

4.2. Focus

It is generally agreed that the constituent in first position in a clause has greater prominence than the other. The topic is often placed in this position. This is sometimes seen as the default situation. From this point of view, comment-initial order is seen as “marked”; a comment used in this position is said to be in “focus.” However, in some cases (as in situations in which Pro2

12. See the problems with “subject” and “predicate” described by Diethelm Michel in “Probleme des Nominalsatzes im biblischen Hebräisch,” *ZAH* 7 (1994) 217. The discussion on pp. 220–22 shows that the terminology he prefers is also not free from problems. Because of such difficulties, in the description above I have used objective terms, and this is continued as far as is possible.

13. I use “topic” as defined by David Crystal, in *A Dictionary of Linguistics and Phonetics* (Oxford: Blackwell, 1980; 3d ed., 1991) 354. This term is sometimes used to refer to an item represented in several successive clauses. See Talmy Givón, “Topic Continuity in Discourse: An Introduction,” in *Topic Continuity in Discourse: A Quantitative Cross-Language Study* (ed. T. Givón; Amsterdam: Benjamins, 1983) 1–41. The term “theme” is used here. “Topic” may also be used, by means of the term “topicalization,” to refer to the initial component of a clause, as in Barry L. Bandstra, “Word Order and Emphasis in Biblical Hebrew Narrative: Observations on Genesis 22 from a Discourse Perspective,” *Linguistics and Biblical Hebrew* (ed. Walter R. Bodine; Winona Lake, Ind.: Eisenbrauns, 1992) 120. Here the constituent is said to be “in first position.”

14. Michel, “Probleme des Nominalsatzes im biblischen Hebräisch,” 217.

15. See Crystal, *Dictionary of Linguistics* (pp. 273, 333), although in origin, “subject” and “predicate” no doubt also referred to semantic rather than to grammatical structure.

order is typical), comment-initial order seems to result from rule-governed variation, so that it is unmarked. If so, the comment in such cases is accorded the prominence typical of first position, nothing more. "Focus" should refer to the deliberate placing of an item in first position in contrast to the expected usage. In most cases where the term "focus" might be used with a looser definition,¹⁶ the clause either appears to belong to a "rule-governed" category or is an example of a type that shows no clear default order. To avoid confusion, the nontechnical term *highlighted* is generally used here in place of "focus."

4.3. Definiteness and Referentiality

Definiteness, long recognized as important for the understanding of verbless clauses, is categorized in various grades. The main basis of the gradation is often specificity of reference, but it appears that a more important aspect of definiteness for the present topic is "referentiality," understood as the degree to which a constituent is co-referent with some item in the context.¹⁷ Referentiality also must be graded. The reference may be "internal": reference to the immediately preceding narrative, or to an item mentioned earlier in the speaker's speech or in the speech of another, to which he is responding. The speaker, addressee, others involved with them, and the immediate physical context of the speech would also be included. The less-important "external" reference is to other information shared by narrator and reader or by speaker and addressee. The relevance of referentiality is also affected by other criteria, such as the proximity of the referent in the preceding context, its categorization as "human" or "other," its degree of specificity, and the directness of the reference in terms of the function of the pronoun that carries it as head or modifier in the constituent. Siewierska includes these factors in the semantic or pragmatic categories conditioning word order.¹⁸

4.4. The Conditioning of Word Order

Where a pronoun acts as a constituent of a verbless clause, Pro1 order is by far the most common over all. Such a pronoun typically represents a theme represented by a noun in the previous context. In the vast majority of cases, if not in all, it also represents both topic and subject in the clause in which it stands. This status is not affected where the clause stands first in a speech or is

16. Revell, *Designation of the Individual*, 379 n. 18.

17. The graded list in Francis I. Andersen, *The Hebrew Verbless Clause in the Pentateuch* (JBL Monograph Series 14; New York and Nashville: Abingdon, 1970) 109 (table 1) is mainly based on specificity of reference. The importance of previous reference in the speech is noted in Takamitsu Muraoka, *Emphatic Words and Structures in Biblical Hebrew* (Jerusalem: Magnes, 1985) 8.

18. Anna Siewierska, *Word Order Rules* (London: Croom Helm, 1988) 263.

introduced by כִּי, situations in which Pro2 order is characteristic. However, the relation of the clause to what precedes is clear in these situations, which is not the case with typical coordinate clauses or asyndeton clauses that do not begin a speech. Clear indication of relationship is also characteristic of the other situations in which Pro2 order is found. The only content of a pronoun representing the topic is referentiality. Clearly, it was desirable to place an item with high referentiality in first position and so to give prominence to the maintenance of thematic continuity (cohesion). Where this continuity is adequately maintained by the use of introductory כִּי or by some other feature of the context, the prominence of initial position can be accorded to the new information presented in the other constituent (the comment, or predicate). The situation just outlined can be considered to represent the unmarked situation and its rule-governed variations. The few examples of exceptional order result from the deliberate highlighting of the item placed in first position: these items are "in focus" (see [6], [7], [8], [14], [15]).

The topic stands first in the majority of verbless clauses (nearly 70% of some 1260 clauses in the corpus). The placing of the topic in first position was clearly desirable. The constituent representing the topic is often also the one with the higher referentiality, as in the examples in which one constituent is a pronoun described in the last paragraph. In this case the two priorities, the claims of higher referentiality and of topic status on first position, do not conflict. An item that carries both features typically stands in first position. Where one constituent is a pronoun bound to a preposition, it has the higher referentiality, but it does not represent the topic, so each constituent has a claim on first position. The choice between the two priorities appears to be determined by the function of the nominal in the narrative. Where the nominal has an important function (usually where it represents a divine or a human participant), it takes first position. The order is PPro2. Where the narrative function of the nominal is of little significance (usually where its referent does not represent such a participant), the constituent containing the pronoun is placed in first position. This PPro1 order gives prominence to the pronoun and so maintains thematic continuity, as does Pro1 order. It appears that the use of introductory כִּי or other features of the context that usually correlate with Pro2 order also correlate with PPro2 order in situations in which PPro1 order is expected under the general description. The same order (Pro2 or PPro2) is also used in a clause coordinate with a clause of this sort. The evidence is limited, but this fact appears to support the view that כִּי affects word order simply because it establishes the relationship of the clause it introduces to what precedes, so that there is no need to place a pronoun in first position for this purpose.

5. One Constituent of the Clause Is Nominal, One Is an Adverb or a Nominal with a Prefixed Preposition

A third-person pronoun is simply the least specific of the range of structures available for the designation of any particular entity. The use of a more specific designation in place of a pronoun does not entail change in structure. Where one constituent of the clause is a noun phrase and the other an adverb or a preposition followed by a noun phrase, the pattern described above is generally followed. In a coordinate clause or an asyndeton clause that does not begin a speech, an adverbial constituent standing in first position typically has a higher degree of referentiality than does the nominal:

(25) 2 Sam 3:7

וּלְשָׂאוֹל פִּלְגֶּשׁ [וְשֵׁמָּה רִצְפָּה] And (belonging) to Saul (was) a concubine, [and her name (was) Rizpah].

The corpus includes 48 examples (A7).

The nominal in second position appears to have a higher degree of referentiality only in Judg 18:6:¹⁹

(26) Judg 18:6

וַיֹּאמֶר לָהֶם הַכֹּהֵן לָכוּ [לְשָׁלוֹם] נִכַח יְהוָה דְּרַכְכֶּם אֲשֶׁר תֵּלְכוּ-בָּהּ: [The priest said to them, "Go in peace.] Before Yahweh (is) your journey on which you are going."

Where the nominal constituent precedes the adverbial in a coordinate clause or an asyndeton clause that does not begin a speech, the nominal is often the more highly referential:

(27) 2 Kgs 9:20

וְהַמְנִיגָה כַּמְנִיגָה יְהוּא בֶן-נִמְשִׁי The driving (is) like the driving of Jehu b. Nimshi.²⁰

In some cases, neither constituent is clearly higher in referentiality:

(28) 2 Kgs 7:1

כֹּה אָמַר יְהוָה [כַּעַת מָחָר סֵאֶה-סֵלֶת בְּשֶׁקֶל וְסֵאֶתִים שְׁעָרִים בְּשֶׁקֶל בְּשַׁעַר שַׁמְרוֹן:] [Thus has Yahweh said,] "At this time tomorrow, a measure of wheat (will be) worth a shekel, and two measures of barley (will be) worth a shekel at the gate of Samaria."

19. The referentiality of the two constituents appears equal in 1 Sam 16:6, where the adverbial is also 'before Yahweh'.

20. The 'driving' is an internal reference, but the personal name, which makes the nominal in the adverbial definite, is an external one.

The initial nominal sometimes has a lower degree of referentiality than the adverbial:

(29) Judg 14:6

[וַיִּשְׁפְּעֶהוּ . . .] וּמֵאוֹמֶה אֵין [He tore it (the lion) apart . . .] and
בְּיָדוֹ nothing (was) in his hand.

The corpus includes 124 examples of coordinate and asyndeton clauses of this sort (A8).

Where the clause is introduced by כִּי, the adverbial typically has higher referentiality.²¹ Nevertheless, it usually stands in second position:

(30) 2 Sam 11:16

[הַמָּקוֹם אֲשֶׁר יָדַע] כִּי . . . the place of which he knew
אֲנָשֵׁי-חַיִּל שָׁם: that men of valor (were) there.

The corpus includes 13 examples (A9).

Where the adverbial stands first in a clause introduced by כִּי, it is reasonable to argue that it is highlighted:

(31) 1 Sam 22:22

[יָדַעְתִּי בַיּוֹם הַהוּא] כִּי-שָׁם [I knew on that day] that there (was)
דּוֹאֵג [ק] הָאֶדְוִמִּי Doeg the Edomite.

Other examples occur in Judg 8:21, 18:14; 1 Sam 2:8, 7:17, 14:6, 17:47, 24:12.²²

A less referential nominal constituent may also be used in first position in asyndeton clauses that stand first in a speech:

(32) 1 Sam 9:6

[וַיֹּאמֶר לוֹ] הֲנֵה-נָא אִישׁ- [He said to him,] "Note, please, a
אֱלֹהִים בְּעִיר הַזֹּאת man of God (lives) in this city. . ."

There are four such examples, five where the initial nominal clearly has higher referentiality (though not necessarily greater specificity), and two in which there is no clear difference. The references to these in A8 are underlined.

21. In some cases, as with בְּקֶרְבוֹ in 1 Kgs 3:28, the adverbial constituent could be classed as a preposition followed by a nominal phrase, 'in his middle', or a compound preposition followed by a pronoun, 'within him'. The former is chosen here, but the classification is not relevant to the argument.

22. In 1 Sam 17:47, such highlighting is given added impact by the repetition of Yahweh where a pronoun would suffice: לֹא בַחֲרֵב וּבַחֲנִית יְהוֹשִׁיעַ יְהוָה כִּי לַיהוָה הַמִּלְחָמָה 'Not by sword and spear does Yahweh liberate, because (belonging) to Yahweh (is) battle' (the definite article used in the Hebrew is generic, not anaphoric). On the function of this sort of repetition of names, see Revell, *Designation of the Individual*, §4.4.

An initial nominal often has lower referentiality in asyndeton or coordinate clauses in passages of extended description:

(33) 1 Sam 17:4–5

וַיֵּצֵא אִישׁ־הַבָּנִים . . . גִּלְיָת	[A champion came out. . . Goliath
שְׁמוֹ . . . גְּבוּהוֹ שֵׁשׁ אַמּוֹת . . .	(was) his name. . . His height
וְכֹבֶעַ נְחֹשֶׁת עַל־רָאשׁוֹ	(was) six cubits. . .] A brass
	helmet (was) on his head.

Other examples occur in 1 Kgs 6:24–25; 7:17, 42; 10:19.

The relative frequency of the use, in these two situations, of an initial nominal with lower referentiality also corresponds with the patterns shown by clauses with a PPro constituent.

Nothing suggests that these examples should not be interpreted in the same way as those with a pronominal constituent. The nominal constituent represents the topic. In a coordinate clause or an asyndeton clause that is not speech-initial, there is a strong tendency to place the adverbial in first position where it has the higher degree of referentiality, just as is true where an adverbial is composed of a pronoun bound to a preposition. However, a nominal standing in second position in these clauses quite often does represent a human participant who has an important role in the following narrative (as in [25]; also 2 Sam 4:4; 9:2, 12; 13:1; etc.), unlike the situation where the adverbial is a preposition followed by a pronoun (see §3.1). This supports the idea that the adverbial is placed in first position mainly to give prominence to an item important for thematic continuity. As has been shown, this continuity can be maintained through features of the context, as speech-initial position, or presence in a passage of description, or by syntactic features such as the use of כִּי. Where this is the case, there is no need to accord first position to the constituent with higher referentiality. Accordingly, in situations of this sort, an adverbial with higher referentiality is placed in second position much more often, just as occurs in such situations where the adverbial is a preposition with pronoun. However, a topic nominal stands in first position much more frequently than does a topic pronoun in such situations. A pronoun carries only referentiality, whereas a nominal carries additional information. An initial particle or a contextual situation that makes it unnecessary to give prominence to referentiality has no relevance for this additional information, which may require the prominence usually accorded to the topic.

6. Both Constituents Are Nominal

6.1. One Constituent Is Headed by a Participle or Adjective

In the majority of clauses composed of two noun phrases, one is substantial (the topic), and the other (the comment) is headed by a participle or

adjective. The topic regularly stands in first position in coordinate clauses (over 95% of some 180 clauses). The proportion is similar in asyndeton clauses that do not begin a speech. Topic-comment order is also used where a component of the comment is preposed, as in the כִּי clauses in 1 Kgs 20:22; 2 Kgs 2:3, 5; 6:9. Where a participle or adjective heading the comment takes first position, any modifiers typically follow the topic in any clause.²³ However, a modifier with high referentiality usually precedes the topic:

(34) 1 Kgs 19:7

[וַיֹּאמֶר קוּם-אֲכַל] כִּי רַב מְמַךְ [He said, "Rise. Eat], for too great
הַדֶּרֶךְ: for you (is) the way."

Other examples occur in Judg 15:11, 20:34; 1 Sam 3:13, 29:6; 2 Sam 14:32.²⁴ There is an exception in 2 Sam 19:43:

(35) 2 Sam 19:43

[וַיַּעַן כָּל-אִישׁ יְהוּדָה עַל-אִישׁ] [All the men of Judah answered the
יִשְׂרָאֵל] כִּי-קָרוֹב הַמֶּלֶךְ אֵלַי men of Israel,] "For closely-related
(is) the king to me."²⁵

Comment-initial order is used more freely in asyndeton clauses that begin a speech (19 of 39 examples) and in clauses introduced by כִּי (13 of 27 examples). This bears out the comment made above. A topic pronoun carries only referentiality. A topic nominal carries other information in addition, which increases the desirability of using it in first position. Most speech-initial asyndeton clauses of this sort with initial comment are used to present a blessing or curse, to express approval or disapproval, or to present a comparison. That is, the head of the comment is to be considered highlighted. The 20 examples in the corpus are listed in A10.²⁶

Some idea of the value of the contrasting orders can be gained through comparison of similar passages. Comment-initial order occurs in 1 Sam 9:10:

(36) 1 Sam 9:10

[וַיֹּאמֶר שְׂאוּל לַנְּעָר] טוֹב [Saul said to his lad,] "Good (is)
דְּבָרְךָ [לָכֵה וְלָכֵה] your word. [Come on. Let us go]."

23. In 1 Kgs 11:28, the nominal object follows the initial participle immediately because the words function substantively.

24. Highly referential items are similarly placed before the topic in PPro1 clauses in Judg 11:34 (מִמֶּנּוּ) and 2 Sam 14:30 (שָׁם). Compare the position of בְּחֻצְרוֹ in 2 Sam 17:18.

25. This example shows that the length of the component, though possibly a conditioning factor, does not determine the choice of position. In 2 Sam 19:43, the marked order can be seen as drawing attention both to the nominal (representing the person over whom speaker and addressee are arguing) and to the pronoun in the adverbial.

26. The content is similar where a comment-first pattern is used in other asyndeton clauses (1 Sam 26:16, 2 Sam 14:32) or in coordinate clauses (1 Sam 25:33, 29:6; 2 Sam 18:3, 22:47).

Topic-first order occurs in similar wording in 2 Sam 15:3:

(37) 2 Sam 15:3

[וַיֹּאמֶר אֵלָיו אֲבִשְׁלוֹם רָאָה]
דְּבָרְךָ טוֹבִים וְנִכְזָרִים [וְשָׁמַע]
אֵין-לְךָ מֵאֵת הַמֶּלֶךְ:]

[Absalom said to him, "Look,] your words (are) good and right, [but there (will be) no listener for you from near the king]." (The government will not listen to you.)

The comment-initial pattern gives prominence to the adjective; the statement indicates approval, encouraging the intended action. The topic-initial pattern gives the adjective no prominence; the statement accepts the argument but discourages the intended action. The corpus includes 20 topic-initial clauses of this sort (A11).

The value of the contrasting orders in clauses introduced by כִּי can similarly be illustrated by comparison. Comment-initial order occurs in 2 Kgs 12:11:

(38) 2 Kgs 12:11

[וַיְהִי כִּרְאוֹתָם] כִּי-רַב הַכֶּסֶף
בְּאֹרֶן . . .

[When they saw] that much (was) the silver in the chest. . . .

The same adjective heads the comment where topic-initial order is used in 1 Sam 12:17:

(39) 1 Sam 12:17

[וַיֵּדְעוּ וַיֵּרְאוּ] כִּי-רַעַתְכֶם רַבָּה
אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתֶם בְּעֵינֵי יְהוָה . . .

[Know and see] that your wickedness (is) much which you have done in the eyes of Yahweh. . . .

The collection of money in a chest is the theme of the context preceding the first example, but the initial adjective 'much' represents the perception that triggered further action and so deserves prominence. In 1 Sam 12:17, the adjective is not given prominence; the unmarked topic-initial order states a fact of which no consequences are represented. The 27 כִּי clauses of this sort in the corpus are listed in A12.

6.2. Both Constituents Are Substantial

Where neither constituent is headed by a participle or adjective, it is still often clear that one (the comment) provides information about the other (the topic). Many clauses of this sort present a number, weight, measure, age, or name. The nominal designating the item to which this information relates, which represents the topic, is also the more highly referential constituent. There is no conflict of priorities, and this nominal typically stands in first position:

(40) 1 Sam 17:5

[וְשָׂרִיזִין קַשְׁקִישִׁים הָיָא לְבוּשׁ]	[Scale-armor he (was) wearing,]
וּמִשְׁקַל הַשְּׂרִיזִין חֲמֵשֶׁת-אֲלָפִים	and the weight of the armour (was)
שְׁקָלִים נְחֹשֶׁת:	5,000 shekels of bronze.

Other examples occur in Judg 8:10; 1 Sam 11:8, 17:7; 2 Sam 12:30, 24:9; 1 Kgs 2:11, 7:32, 11:42, 14:20, 18:22; 2 Kgs 10:36, 25:17. Similarly, in a clause that gives the name of a character, the constituent identifying the character named, which represents the topic and is also the more highly referential, stands first, just as it does where a pronoun is used for this purpose:²⁷

(41) Judg 17:1

[וַיְהִי-אִישׁ מִהַר-אֶפְרַיִם]	[There was a man from Mount
וּשְׁמוֹ מִיכָיָהוּ:	Ephraim] and his name (was)
	Micaiah.

Where the clause is asyndeton, this topic-initial order is often reversed. This occurs with statements of length or height in the description of the Temple and its furnishings, already noted as passages in which unusual word order is characteristic.²⁸ A clause giving the age of the king in this form typically follows (immediately or closely) a statement that he became king:

(42) 2 Sam 5:3-4

[וַיִּמְשְׁחוּ אֶת-דָּוִד לְמֶלֶךְ עַל-]	[They anointed David as king over
יִשְׂרָאֵל:] בֶּן-שְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה	Israel.] Thirty years old (was)
דָּוִד בְּמָלְכוֹ . . .	David when he became king. . . .

The corpus includes 14 examples (A13).

A naming clause showing this order stands in quasi-appositional relationship immediately or soon after a character has been introduced but not named:

(43) 2 Sam 20:21

[אִישׁ מִהַר אֶפְרַיִם] שֶׁבַע	[A man from Mount Ephraim]
בֶּן-בְּכָרִי שְׁמוֹ . . .	Sheba b. Bichri (was) his name.

(See also [33].) The name is presumably highlighted in such cases. The choice of this form of presentation may indicate that the name was expected to be

27. Other examples of naming clauses of this sort are quoted in (19), (25). In all, there are 57 in the corpus. Where several characters are named together, the nominal identifying the individual named is placed first in 1 Sam 1:2, 14:49, and (following וַיְהִי) in 1 Sam 8:2, 2 Sam 3:2. An exception occurs in 1 Sam 17:13. Here, the word "name" is used only in the introduction to the list, not in the clauses forming it as well, as is the case in 1 Sam 14:49, a fact possibly related to the difference in order.

28. 1 Kgs 6:3, 10, 23, 24; 7:2, 6, 15, 23, 27, 38. The clause in 2 Kgs 25:17 occurs in the description of some of those furnishings taken as booty

well known to the reader or to the addressee.²⁹ Compare the topic-initial order used where the narrator's concern is simply to provide information:

(44) 1 Sam 1:2

[וְלוֹ שְׁתֵּי נָשִׁים] שֵׁם אֶתָּה חַנָּה [He had two wives.] The name of
[וְשֵׁם הַשֵּׁנִית פְּנִינָה] one (was) Hannah, [and the name of
the second (was) Peninah].

In a few asyndeton clauses, the topic is placed first, and the age or measurement follows, as in the default order. Where this occurs, the presentation of age or measurement is unexpected. The context gives the reader no reason to expect a statement of Goliath's height in 1 Sam 17:4 (33). The statement concerning the height of a cherub in 1 Kgs 6:26 follows what could easily be taken as the end of the description of the size of the cherubim. Topic-initial order is used in a statement of age in 1 Kgs 22:42:

(45) 1 Kgs 22:42

יְהוֹשָׁפָט בֶּן-שְׁלֹשִׁים וְחָמֵשׁ יְהוֹשָׁפָט (was) thirty-five years
שָׁנָה בְּמָלְכוֹ old when he became king.

Jehoshaphat is the first of the two kings mentioned in the statement of synchronic date given in the preceding verse. Such age-statements typically refer to the second. The topic is no doubt given prominence to obviate confusion.

7. Conclusion

Michel sees the difference between the two types of naming clauses as syntactic: coordinate clauses are 'dependent' (*hypotaktisch*); asyndeton are 'non-dependent' (*unabhängig*).³⁰ This is clearly true in terms of the use of the conjunction, but this fact in itself does not determine word order.³¹ Beyond that, there appears to be no significant difference in the situations in which the two types of clauses are used in 2 Sam 16:5 and 1 Sam 17:23 (relating to the subject of a clause with a participial predicate introduced by וְהִנֵּה) or in Judg 16:4 and 1 Sam 17:4 (relating to a nominal in the preceding narrative clause). If clauses other than this naming type are included, the list can easily be extended.

29. Other cases occur in 1 Sam 17:23, 25:25; 2 Sam 20:21; and 1 Kgs 13:2. The name is also placed first in Judg 18:29 to highlight a contrast also marked by וְאוֹלָם (cf. Gen 28:19). Like כִּי, this particle shows specifically how what follows relates to what precedes.

30. Michel, "Probleme des Nominalsatzes im biblischen Hebräisch," 222-23.

31. See Alviero Niccacci in "Simple Nominal Clause (SNC) or Verbless Clause in Biblical Hebrew Prose," *ZAH* 6 (1993) 222 (on his examples 19 and 20).

The above discussion suggests that word order is to a large extent conditioned by the desirability, for purposes of communication, of giving the prominence afforded by first position to the constituent representing the topic of the clause and also to the constituent that has the higher referentiality and therefore is best suited to maintaining thematic continuity. Where one constituent carries both features, it is typically placed first. Under certain conditions, this order is reversed. These conditions can to a large extent be described in terms of syntax. In a small proportion of cases, however, the initial constituent is "in focus." It is given first position in contrast to the common pattern according to the particular communicative purposes of the narrator or speaker.

Where topic status and higher referentiality are carried by different constituents, either may be placed in first position. The topic is more commonly found in this position but not so often as to justify calling this the default order. The choice of order seems to be conditioned by the content of the context rather than by its grammatical structure. No doubt further study will make possible a more comprehensive and more objective description of the conditioning of word order in such clauses than has been attempted above. No doubt also further study of verbless clauses from different viewpoints will increase our knowledge of the implications of word order in any given situation. Since semantic and pragmatic factors are involved, however, a comprehensive and also wholly objective description is scarcely to be expected from our distant vantage point.

APPENDIX

A1. Pro1 clauses, standard examples

1a. Coordinate clauses

Judg 3:20, 25, 27; 4:2, 5, 21; 9:31; 10:1; 11:1, 34; 13:9, 18; 17:7 (2x); 18:28; 19:16

1 Sam 1:10; 9:22; 10:5; 16:12; 17:5, 23; 19:9; 21:6; 23:1; 25:17, 36; 28:14

2 Sam 4:5, 7; 11:4; 13:8; 15:30; 17:2, 10; 21:16; 23:18; 24:13

1 Kgs 1:6, 22, 25; 10:25; 11:29; 14:5; 16:9; 19:19 (2x); 20:12

2 Kgs 2:12, 18, 23; 4:5; 5:18; 6:30; 14:21; 17:26, 34; 22:14

1b. Asyndeton clauses

Judg 1:26; 7:1; 19:10

1 Sam 4:8; 8:8

2 Sam 5:7; 18:14

1 Kgs 1:45; 3:3, 27; 6:1, 17, 38; 8:1, 2

2 Kgs 7:13 (2x), 15:12; 17:34; 18:9; 25:8

1c. "Synchronous pairs"

Judg 18:3; 19:11, 22

1 Sam 9:11, 14, 27

2 Sam 13:30; 20:8

1 Kgs 1:42; 14:17

2 Kgs 2:11; 4:5; 6:33; 8:5; 13:21; 19:37

A2. Pro1 clauses with an extraposed constituent

Judg 4:4

1 Sam 11:7; 13:7; 17:14; 21:10

2 Sam 23:18

1 Kgs 8:60; 14:19; 18:24, 39 (2×)

2 Kgs 15:11, 15, 26, 31; 17:41

A3. Pro2 asyndeton clauses beginning a speech

Judg 3:24; 8:19; 9:3; 20:32, 39

1 Sam 19:14; 20:26

1 Kgs 13:26; 22:32

2 Kgs 1:8; 9:36

A4. Pro2 ו clauses

Judg 6:22; 8:5, 24; 9:18; 13:16, 21; 14:4; 18:26, 28

1 Sam 12:21; 15:29; 20:31, 33; 22:17; 24:7; 25:25; 28:14

2 Sam 13:2; 17:8; 19:33

1 Kgs 8:51; 11:28; 14:5; 18:27; 20:31, 41

2 Kgs 4:9; 5:7; 8:27, 29; 9:34; 18:36; 19:18

A5. PPro1 clauses: The referent of the nominal is nonhuman

Judg 3:16; 6:5; 11:34; 19:10

1 Sam 10:5; 18:8; 25:2, 36

2 Sam 13:18; 14:30; 16:1; 17:18; 20:8; 23:18

A6. PPro2 clauses: The referent of the nominal is a participant

Judg 1:22; 4:14; 8:10; 13:9; 19:3, 10

1 Sam 10:10; 14:13; 16:18; 17:41; 18:14; 20:35

2 Sam 5:10; 10:8, 16; 16:1, 15; 19:18 (2×)

1 Kgs 11:29; 18:7; 19:9; 20:1

2 Kgs 8:21; 23:2; 25:25

A7. Clauses with initial nonpronominal adverbial

Judg 6:37; 7:12, 20; 16:27 (2×); 18:6; 20:16; 21:9

1 Sam 1:2 (2×), 3; 14:4; 16:6; 20:18; 27:11; 28:24

2 Sam 3:7; 4:4; 9:2, 10, 12; 12:3; 13:1, 3; 16:23; 17:3; 23:21

1 Kgs 4:7; 6:20, 26; 7:22, 29 (3×), 35 (2×); 8:9; 19:11 (3×), 12 (3×); 20:40

2 Kgs 3:11; 10:1; 18:21

A8. Clauses with a nonpronominal adverbial in second position

8a. The nominal has higher referentiality

Judg 1:36; 4:22; 8:10; 13:6; 16:15, 29 (2×); 19:16, 27; 20:18³²
 1 Sam 4:12; 14:2; 17:7; 18:10; 19:19; 23:15, 24, 26; 24:2; 25:2; 28:7
 2 Sam 2:16; 16:2 (3×), 23; 20:23 (2×), 24; 21:16, 19; 24:22
 1 Kgs 2:39; 4:4, 5, 6 (2×); 5:28; 6:27; 7:18, 32; 10:28
 2 Kgs 5:3; 9:20

8b. The nominal has lower referentiality

Judg 7:16; 14:6, 8; 19:19 (2×); 21:17
 1 Sam 2:13; 9:6; 17:5, 6 (2×), 57
 2 Sam 1:2; 15:32; 18:29; 22:10
 1 Kgs 3:18; 5:28; 6:18; 6:24, 25; 7:2, 6 (2×), 17 (2×), 20, 24, 30 (2×),
 31, 32 (2×), 33, 34, 38, 42; 10:19 (3×); 12:16; 22:48
 2 Kgs 4:40; 11:14; 25:4, 17

8c. There is no clear difference in level of referentiality

Judg 17:6; 18:1; 19:1; 21:19, 25
 1 Sam 7:17; 17:40; 18:25; 19:9, 16; 20:5; 25:2
 2 Sam 8:16; 15:16, 17; 23:2; 24:22
 1 Kgs 3:18; 6:3, 8; 7:28, 32 (2×), 34, 38; 11:29
 2 Kgs 4:38; 6:30; 7:1 (2×), 4, 7, 10; 10:24

A9. כִּי clauses composed of a nominal constituent followed by an adverbial

Judg 4:17
 1 Sam 6:4; 9:12; 17:46; 18:28; 21:10; 22:17
 2 Sam 11:16; 14:1
 1 Kgs 3:28; 10:22
 2 Kgs 5:8, 15

A10. Speech-initial clauses with initial constituent headed by a participle or adjective

Blessing or curse (בִּרְכָּה or אָרוּר)

Judg 17:2; 21:18
 1 Sam 14:24, 28; 25:39
 2 Sam 18:28
 1 Kgs 1:48; 5:21; 8:15; 8:56

Approval or disapproval

1 Sam 9:10
 2 Sam 17:7
 1 Kgs 2:38, 42; 18:24

32. References to asyndeton clauses that begin a speech are underlined.

Comparison (adjective plus מן)

Judg 7:2

2 Sam 17:14

1 Kgs 12:28

Other:

1 Sam 19:2

and (where the speech is introduced by כי)

2 Sam 19:43

A11. Speech-initial clauses with a constituent headed by a participle or adjective in second position

1 Sam 14:11, 33; 16:15; 23:1; 24:10; 28:14

2 Sam 11:11; 12:22; 15:3; 18:26; 19:2, 9; 20:21

1 Kgs 1:51; 13:2; 14:5; 18:44

2 Kgs 2:19; 6:1; 20:17

A12. כי clauses with one constituent headed by a participle or adjective

The head of the comment stands first in

Judg 15:11; 20:34

1 Sam 2:24; 3:13, 20; 23:10; 30:6

2 Sam 13:15; 17:10; 24:14

1 Kgs 19:7

2 Kgs 6:16; 12:11; 22:13

The topic stands first in

1 Sam 3:8; 12:17; 19:4; 26:12

2 Sam 12:19

1 Kgs 8:7, 64; 21:15

2 Kgs 4:27

and with a component of the comment preposed

1 Kgs 20:22

2 Kgs 2:3, 5; 6:9

A13. Asyndeton clauses giving age showing comment-initial order

The clause closely follows a statement of accession in

2 Sam 2:10; 5:4

1 Kgs 14:21

2 Kgs 8:26; 16:2; 21:1, 19; 22:1; 23:31, 36; 24:8, 18. Cf. the similar, formally verbal, clauses in 2 Kgs 8:17; 14:2; 15:2, 33; 18:2.

The clause in 1 Sam 13:1 is separated from the statement that Saul was made king (1 Sam 11:15) by Samuel's sermon on the establishment of a king in chapter twelve. 2 Kgs 12:1 follows the detailed description of the installation of the king in chap. 11.